1.3 | CORE LESSON: ONE ON ONE TIME (50 MIN)

OVERVIEW

Briefly introduce the main goal of the core lesson to the parents. You can say something like:

"Today's main goal is to learn how we can build positive relationships with our children through one-on-one time. Let's look at a video story…"

Then move on to the video stories.

VIDEO STORIES & ROLE PLAY

VIDEO STORY 1: ONE-ON-ONE TIME WITH YOUR TEEN

Show the video of a father and his teen son spending One-on-One Time together.

Click here to watch the video

After watching the video together, facilitate a discussion with the group. You may have to rephrase the questions as well as allow enough time for parents to respond.

Guiding questions about the video for discussion:

For caregiver groups of children 10-17

1. How does Roberto introduce One-on-One Time?
2. Why did Roberto say how long One-on-One Time would be?
3. How does Roberto show he is paying attention?
4. How does Roberto allow Daniel to lead?
5. How does Miguel feel when his father ignores the message?

During the discussion, remember to connect responses to the Building Blocks for spending One-on-One time with your pre-adolescent or teenager. Remember to write these down on the flip chart:

BUILDING BLOCKS (teens)

- One-on-One Time is special time that you and your child spend together doing and/or talking about something enjoyable.
- Give them all of your attention.
- Listen to your child when they are talking to you.
- Use eye contact with your child and notice what s/he is doing.
- Respond with interest and ask follow-up questions.
- Use physical contact (such as touch or hugs) with your child as appropriate.
- Use your child's name when you speak to him or her.

2nd PRACTICE: ONE-ON-ONE TIME IN A ROLE-PLAY IN THE BIG GROUP

Invite participants to role-play the **Video Story 1** scenario that they just discussed. This will enable them to practice the building blocks for spending One-on-One Time with teenagers.

Here are the steps that can be followed during the role play. Allow the volunteers to offer their own suggestions or things to say, as long as they reflect the Building Blocks above:

1. Ask for two volunteers (one person to play the role of the father and one to play the role of Miguel). The volunteer who plays the role of the father should be the caregiver of a pre-adolescent or teenager (aged 10-17 years). Both persons come to the centre of the circle and face the group.
2. Explain what should happen during the role play:
    a. Miguel has arrived home from school and the father tells him that he wants to hear all about his day.
    b. Miguel describes his day.
    c. The father follows all the building blocks using his words and body language (giving all of his attention, listening when he is talking, using eye contact, responding with interest and asking follow-up questions, using physical contact when appropriate).
3. After the role play is completed, praise the two volunteers and encourage the group to give them a round of applause. You can give each volunteer a sticker on their name tag as a small reward.
4. Ask the two participants how they felt during this role play. Ask Miguel first, and then ask the father.

5. Ask the participant who played the father if they think they can practice this skill at home with their child. Encourage them and express confidence that they can do it!

DISCUSSION: BENEFITS OF ONE-ON-ONE TIME

Lead participants in a group discussion about the benefits of spending One-on-One Time with each other.

Guiding questions for this discussion are:

- How would spending One-on-One Time change your relationship with your child?
- How would you and your child benefit from the One-on-One Time? What would you or they learn or gain from the experience?
- Why would you want to **actively listen** to your child during One-on-One Time? What does **active listening** mean to you?

On the flip chart, write down participants' ideas as principles about WHY they should spend One-on-One Time together. Make sure that you are modelling active listening!

Try to draw out the following benefits of One-on-One Time from the discussion:

- One-on-One Time improves the relationship between parents/caregivers and children.
- Children feel valuable and loved.
- Shows your children that you think that what they are doing is important.
- Increases trust and improves communication between parents and children.
- Listening carefully to children and valuing their ideas encourages them to think for themselves and take the lead in other areas of their lives.

- Gives parents a chance to learn a lot about their childrens' interests and abilities.
- School-related activities can be an opportunity for One-on-One-time and can motivate children in their schoolwork.
- For young children, new vocabulary used during one-on-one time can be an opportunity to learn new words.

PLEASE NOTE! The list above is just a suggestion. Try to identify most of these benefits together. Parents may also provide other reasons about why spending One-on-One may be a positive experience for parents and children. This is wonderful!!

DISCUSSION: ACTIVITIES TO DO DURING ONE-ON-ONE TIME

Lead participants in a group discussion to identify possible activities they can do during One-on-One Time.

It can be challenging for participants to know what to do with their children – especially if there is only a little time to spend together and/or they do not have a good relationship between them.

Ask participants to think of activities that they could do together. These activities should ideally be things that do not involve a screen, such as a phone, tablet, or TV. These activities could be things that the child likes to do, or a chore that parent and child could do together (instead of parents making their child do the chore by themselves).

It can even be a conversation about the day – whatever the child wants within acceptable limits! It is important that the activity is something that is FREE and REALISTIC!

Write the suggestions on the flipchart.

Possible activities:

- Talking about the day
- Talking about something your child likes, such as sports, T.V. show, friends
- Doing a chore together
- Making and/or eating a meal together
- Telling a story
- Going for a walk at the park
- Looking at or reading a story book together
- Playing a game or building a puzzle together
- Playing with toys together

PRACTICING SKILLS IN PAIRS: ONE-ON-ONE TIME

Practicing skills in pairs allows participants to try out their home activities in the safe environment of the group. They also have the opportunity to experience a scenario from the perspective of their child.

Format for practicing in pairs:

A. Introduction

- Introduce that participants are now going to practise spending One-on-One Time together in pairs using Active Listening skills.
- Explain that practicing now will make it easier to do the activities at home, especially since this might be a new thing.
- Explain that everyone will get a chance to practise new skills before using them at home.

B. Practicing in pairs

- Ask parents to think about what activity they would like to do together with their child that would allow them to spend One-on-One Time together. They can choose from the list or come up with a new one.
- Parents should then find a partner in the room. Where possible, parents with young children (age 2-9) should pair with another parent who has a young child, and parents of adolescents (10-17) should pair with another parent who has an adolescent.
- Each pair should take turns practicing how they will spend One-on-One time with their child. Each person will play a parent role playing their chosen activity, as well as a child role playing

what the other parent has chosen as their activity.

- The practice should be brief, with only a few minutes per turn!
- The facilitator should walk around the group and provide support when needed.

C. Discussion

- If you have enough time, ask for feedback from each pair in a group discussion on how the practice went. If you are short on time, ask for 2-3 volunteer pairs to share their experiences.
- OPTIONAL: If you have time, you can play a group game. Ask one pair to show the group what activity they have chosen for One-on-One Time. They must do this in silence, while others in the group have to guess what activity was chosen.

REVIEW: TIPS FOR ONE-ONE-ONE TIME

Discuss the tips for **One-on-One Time** in the large group. Go through each point together. Your co-facilitator helping you can write them down on the flip chart for everyone to see.

1. Set aside a specific time to spend **One-on-One Time** with your child each day.

   Choose a time when you and your child are unlikely to be interrupted and when your child does not have something else that they want to do, like watching TV. ***Switch off the television and put away tablets and phones.***

   2. Tell your child that you would like to spend some time with them and that they can choose what to do or talk about. If you only have 5 minutes available, specify this from the start.

   Your child might think this is weird at first but will gradually start to enjoy having this dedicated time with you!

3. **Give your child all of your attention.**

   Make sure that you will not be distracted by other people or other responsibilities so that you can give all of your attention to your child.

4. **Physically and verbally acknowledge** that you are listening to your child.

   Use lots of eye contact and your child's name. Nodding or saying "I understand" shows them you are really paying attention. **Accept** what your child is saying without judging or trying to lecture them.

5. Give as few **instructions** or directions as possible.

When you are spending One-on-One Time with your child, they should choose and lead the activity. If your child asks a question, you can answer, but try to avoid telling them what to do or judging them. Put the choice back to the child: "That is an interesting question, what do you think?"

6. **Repeat back what your child says when they speak to you.** You can use different words to show that you are really listening to your child. For example, if you child says, "This puzzle is really hard," you can respond, "Yeah, I see that you are finding it difficult."

7. Try to do something different than watching a screen (e.g., TV, phone, tablet).

This is a lot more useful and enjoyable for your child than just sitting together in front of the television or playing with a phone. At first, if your child is resistant to doing something else, you can start by watching your child's favourite TV programme with them or watching funny videos together on YouTube. They may feel comfortable doing other activities with time.

8. Make only **positive comments** and avoid critical comments.

Remember this is your child's activity and an opportunity to strengthen your relationship with your child. Can you think how you have felt recently when someone has been critical of you? There is no right or wrong during One-on-One Time. The parents' job is to show an interest and say something encouraging and nice.

9. When you become better at paying attention to your child during One-on-One Time, start to **do it at other times.**

When you feel confident about paying attention to your child during One-on-One Time, you can involve yourself in other activities with your child.